

Snippets

Government releases draft policy on defence production

Ministry of Defence has come out with a draft policy that envisages achieving a turnover of ₹ 1700 billion in military goods and services by 2025 by making additional investments of nearly ₹ 700 billion and creating employment for nearly two to three million people. The aim is to make India one of the top five manufacturers of defence platforms with active participation from both public and private sectors.

BEL, L&T sign MoU

Bharat Electronics Ltd (BEL) and Larsen & Toubro (L&T) signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU), at Defence Expo 2018 held in Chennai on April 11, to share their expertise in design, development, engineering and manufacturing to develop products and systems to meet the requirement of the defence services and export markets.

Bangladesh to buy solar power from India

Power-starved Bangladesh wants to buy at least 2GW of solar power from the solar parks being set up in the states of Gujarat and Rajasthan. The deal could be seen as part of India's energy diplomacy, at a time when China is showing interest in supporting its neighbouring countries' energy needs.

Videocon may exit Philips, Electrolux pact

Financially-distressed Videocon Group may give up its India rights for two global brands—Philips in the TV business and Electrolux in appliances—after being unable to sustain production without working capital, which has caused a steep decline in sales.

Microlease opens test centre of excellence in India

Microlease unveils a pay-as-you-go test facility for start-ups and small- to medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) in India. Microlease Test Centre of Excellence will allow companies to reduce product development cycle times by providing flexible, low-cost access to the latest test technology.

Apple becomes leader in renewable energy

Apple announced that all of their facilities are now officially powered by 100 per cent clean energy. This includes all their retail stores, offices, data centres and co-located facilities in 43 countries, including the US, the UK, China and India. In addition to all their facilities, nine additional manufacturing partners have committed to power all of their Apple production with 100 per cent clean energy, bringing the total number of committed partners to 23.

Indian power minister appeals to battery manufacturers

Indian power minister, R.K. Singh, recently chaired a meeting with battery-based energy storage manufacturers, calling on them to set up manufacturing units in India. Singh's urgency not only stemmed from the government's electric vehicles focus and this segment's expected growth in the coming years, but also because future tenders will require hybrid solar and wind projects to be coupled with energy storage.

Singh assured the battery manufacturers present in the meeting that the government will take all possible measures to incentivise battery manufacturing in India. With respect to the raw materials necessary for battery manufacturing, he said that the government had already started discussions with resource-rich countries such as Bolivia.

However, industry representatives raised concerns about high GST tax rates on batteries, and asked that preference be given to India-made batteries in government procurement to promote domestic manufacturing.

Robotics witnesses highest investors-to-idea ratio

According to GlobalData, a leading data and analytics company, among all emerging tech companies globally, those working on robotics have witnessed the highest investor interest with a significant 2.93 investors-to-idea ratio (number of venture capital investors/number of funded companies/ideas) in 2017.

Although artificial intelligence (AI) is ahead of all technologies in terms of volume, robotics has the edge over others in terms of investors-to-idea ratio. The rise in interest for robotics is also supported by the average deal value recorded in this segment, which is the second highest at US\$ 28 million compared to AI's US\$ 18 million.

Blockchain saw the lowest investor interest as well as the lowest average deal value among all technologies, with a 1.23 investors-to-idea ratio and US\$ 12 million, respectively, in 2017.

The analysis noted a mixed result for connected devices and the Internet of Things segment, which stood atop the average deal value chart with US\$ 29.5 million, but slipped to third in terms of interest at a 2.62 investors-to-idea ratio.

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Calendar of Forthcoming Electronics Fairs/Exhibitions/Seminars/Events

Name, Date and Venue	Topics	Contact address for details
India IT Week October 11-12, 2018 NIMHANS Convention Center Bengaluru	Platform for the open source community to share what's new and exciting in open source languages, tools and techniques	Website: https://opensourceindia.in/osdays
GITEX October 14-18, 2018 Dubai World Trade Centre	Showcase of the world's most advanced technologies	Website: www.gitex.com/
electronics Munich Nov. 13-16, 2018 Munich, Germany	International trade fair for electronic components, systems and applications	Website: www.electronicade
India Electronics Week (IEW) 2019 February 26-28, 2019 KTPO Trade Center, Whitefield Industrial Area, Bengaluru	Technology-centric show that showcases latest products, solutions and industry's best practices, involving design and manufacture electronics, to make products smarter	IEW 2019 Website: www.indiaelectronicsweek.com

Since this information is subject to change, all those interested are advised to ascertain the details from the organisers before making any commitment.

Solar Mission seems firmly on its path to achieve the target of 100GW of grid-connected solar power by 2022. However, a lot needs to be done to improve domestic manufacturing and to develop a competitive industry with

qualified manpower. It was also stated that the solar rooftop programme needs to be strengthened and market innovations are required so that a large market for distributed solar power can be developed in a short time.